

# Evidence Axis

## telli Evidence Appendix

**Gift #14 | Public competitive evidence | Checked 2 Sep 2026**

Scope. This appendix supports the Executive Brief. It tests one live telli comparison surface against dated and current public evidence from ElevenLabs, with a narrow focus on outbound workflow capability, agent-builder accessibility, and the historical technology-layer relationship. It is not a full voice-AI market map.

### 1. Claim legend

| Label           | Meaning                                                                                |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FACT            | Directly supported by cited public evidence.                                           |
| INFERENCE       | Reasoned interpretation from verified facts. Not presented as a proven internal state. |
| NOT ESTABLISHED | Searched or considered, but not proven by the public evidence reviewed.                |

### 2. Final findings

Finding 1 - The outbound boundary appears to have been too broad before telli's own January 2026 cutoff. FACT: telli's live ElevenLabs page says the platform has limited batch interactions, no built-in campaign management, and should not be chosen for outbound sales. FACT: ElevenLabs launched a documented Batch Calling product on 28 May 2025 with recipient-list upload, personalization variables, scheduling, monitoring, reporting and API access. FACT: on 3 Sep 2025 ElevenLabs said customers were using Agents to qualify leads and run outbound calling at scale. INFERENCE: the blanket outbound exclusion was broader than the public evidence available before telli's stated snapshot.

Finding 2 - The developer/no-code boundary followed a different timeline. FACT: on 3 Sep 2025 ElevenLabs still listed a visual workflow builder as coming soon. FACT: on 17 Feb 2026 ElevenAgents for Support described workflows without code and a no-code interface for non-technical teams. FACT: the current ElevenLabs sales page advertises no-code call flows, an intuitive drag-and-drop builder, sales templates, and Salesforce/HubSpot plus calendar integration. INFERENCE: telli's developer-focused framing may have been more defensible around the original snapshot, but has since materially weakened.

**Guardrail: The evidence does not establish feature parity, superior product quality, lost deals, or that telli's entire January benchmark was wrong. It isolates specific public claims whose evidence status differs.**

### 3. Source register

| ID | Source                                                       | Class                                         | Date / location                     | Use                                                                                                           |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| S1 | telli - ElevenLabs Review & Best Alternatives                | Company / competitor-authored                 | telli.com, live; checked 2 Sep 2026 | Live decision guide, workflow score/narrative, builder framing, January 2026 methodology                      |
| S2 | ElevenLabs - Introducing batch calling for Conversational AI | Competitor primary                            | 28 May 2025                         | Self-serve outbound batch feature: CSV/XLS, variables, scheduling, monitoring, reporting, API                 |
| S3 | ElevenLabs - Introducing ElevenLabs Agents                   | Competitor primary                            | 3 Sep 2025                          | Complete-platform framing; lead qualification; outbound calling at scale; visual workflow builder coming soon |
| S4 | TechCrunch - telli pre-seed profile                          | Independent media with direct CEO attribution | 15 Apr 2025                         | Historical use of ElevenLabs or Cartesia for cloning voices used by telli                                     |

Source register continues on the next page.

### 3. Source register - continued

| ID | Source                                                 | Class              | Date / location             | Use                                                                                                          |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| S5 | ElevenLabs - Series D announcement                     | Company / primary  | 4 Feb 2026                  | \$500M Series D; \$11B valuation; investment in ElevenAgents across CX, sales, marketing, internal workflows |
| S6 | ElevenLabs - Introducing ElevenAgents for Support      | Competitor primary | 17 Feb 2026                 | Workflows without code; non-technical teams update in no-code interface                                      |
| S7 | ElevenLabs - AI Phone Agent for Sales & SDR Teams      | Competitor primary | Current; checked 2 Sep 2026 | Outbound sales, batch calling, voicemail detection, no-code call flows, CRM/calendar integrations            |
| S8 | ElevenLabs - How our AI SDR qualifies leads in minutes | Competitor primary | 2 Sep 2026                  | Dom inbound production proof; \$1M+ qualified pipeline; 92% accuracy; 180 SDR hours; outbound is next step   |

Source hygiene. The TechCrunch URL used here is the corrected /telli-a-yc-alum-raises-pre-seed-funding-for-its-ai-voice-agents/ path. No LinkedIn evidence is used.

## 4. Claim map

| ID  | Status | Allowed claim                                                                                                                             | Evidence |
|-----|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| C01 | FACT   | telli says ElevenLabs is not ideal for end-to-end call automation/workflow management.                                                    | S1       |
| C02 | FACT   | telli labels the Agent Builder developer-focused and says it lacks an easy-to-use builder.                                                | S1       |
| C03 | FACT   | telli says not to choose ElevenLabs for full call automation or outbound sales/support operations.                                        | S1       |
| C04 | FACT   | telli says its benchmark uses public evidence as of January 2026.                                                                         | S1       |
| C25 | FACT   | ElevenLabs shipped Batch Calling on 28 May 2025 with CSV/XLS upload, dynamic variables, scheduling, monitoring, reporting and API access. | S2       |
| C06 | FACT   | By 3 Sep 2025 ElevenLabs said customers were qualifying leads and running outbound calling at scale.                                      | S3       |
| C07 | FACT   | On 3 Sep 2025 the visual workflow builder was still listed as coming soon.                                                                | S3       |

Claim map continues on the next page.

## 4. Claim map - continued

| ID  | Status    | Allowed claim                                                                                            | Evidence |
|-----|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| C08 | INFERENCE | The blanket outbound exclusion appears overbroad relative to evidence available before the cutoff.       | S1-S3    |
| C09 | INFERENCE | The developer-focused characterization may have been more defensible around the original snapshot.       | S1,S3    |
| C10 | FACT      | By 17 Feb 2026 non-technical teams could update workflows in a no-code interface.                        | S6       |
| C11 | FACT      | Current sales product advertises no-code drag-and-drop call flows and sales templates.                   | S7       |
| C12 | FACT      | Current sales product advertises outbound campaigns/cold calling, batch calling and voicemail detection. | S7       |
| C13 | FACT      | Current product advertises Salesforce/HubSpot updates and calendar sync.                                 | S7       |
| C14 | INFERENCE | telli's current developer-focused/no-code framing has materially weakened since its stated snapshot.     | S1,S6,S7 |

Claim map continues on the next page.

## 4. Claim map - continued

| ID  | Status          | Allowed claim                                                                                     | Evidence     |
|-----|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| C15 | FACT            | In Apr 2025 telli's CEO said voices were cloned using ElevenLabs or Cartesia.                     | S4           |
| C16 | NOT ESTABLISHED | telli still uses ElevenLabs today.                                                                | DO NOT CLAIM |
| C18 | FACT            | Dom handled \$1M+ qualified pipeline, 92% accuracy and saved 180 SDR hours in the reported month. | S8           |
| C19 | FACT            | Dom is inbound today; outbound sequences are described as a next step.                            | S8           |
| C20 | NOT ALLOWED     | Dom proves current outbound production performance.                                               | DO NOT CLAIM |
| C21 | NOT ALLOWED     | telli's January benchmark was entirely wrong.                                                     | DO NOT CLAIM |
| C22 | NOT ALLOWED     | ElevenLabs has parity with telli.                                                                 | DO NOT CLAIM |

# 5. Finding 1 evidence - outbound and campaign workflow

| Evidence point                                                                                                                            | Status    | Source |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|--------|
| telli Workflow Automation is scored 2.0/5 and says ElevenLabs has limited batch interactions.                                             | FACT      | S1     |
| telli says ElevenLabs is not designed for scheduling, callbacks or multi-step automation and requires external tools for full automation. | FACT      | S1     |
| telli's Pros/Cons says "No built-in automation or campaign management."                                                                   | FACT      | S1     |
| telli says do not choose ElevenLabs if you need full call automation or run outbound sales/support operations.                            | FACT      | S1     |
| ElevenLabs Batch Calling launched 28 May 2025 and automates multiple concurrent outbound calls.                                           | FACT      | S2     |
| Batch Calling includes CSV/XLS upload, dynamic variables, scheduling, real-time monitoring, reports and API access.                       | FACT      | S2     |
| ElevenLabs said on 3 Sep 2025 that customers were qualifying leads and running outbound calling at scale.                                 | FACT      | S3     |
| The live telli outbound exclusion is broader than pre-cutoff public evidence supports.                                                    | INFERENCE | S1-S3  |

**Guardrail.** Do not state that ElevenLabs had parity with telli in May or September 2025. The specific conclusion is about the breadth of telli's buyer-facing exclusion, not the overall platform score.

# 5. Finding 1 evidence - timeline and interpretation

| Date        | Observed public state                                                                                                                                    | EA read                                                                                |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 28 May 2025 | Batch Calling ships with self-serve list upload, personalization, scheduling, monitoring, reporting and API.                                             | Specific outbound campaign capability existed before the benchmark cutoff.             |
| 3 Sep 2025  | Agents described as complete platform; customers use it for lead qualification and outbound calling at scale. Visual workflow builder still coming soon. | Outbound capability and builder usability were not on the same maturity clock.         |
| Jan 2026    | telli says benchmark reflects this snapshot.                                                                                                             | Outbound exclusion must be read against capabilities that were already public by then. |

## Decision interpretation

INFERENCE. The low-regret action is not simply to add a Batch Calling tick. It is to rewrite the outbound comparison around narrower, durable differences that remain true even when ElevenLabs adds campaign and telephony features.



## 6. Finding 2 evidence - builder / no-code

| Evidence point                                                                                                            | Status    | Source       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|--------------|
| telli currently labels ElevenLabs' Agent Builder "Developer-Focused" and says it lacks an easy-to-use builder.            | FACT      | S1           |
| On 3 Sep 2025 ElevenLabs listed the visual workflow builder as "coming soon."                                             | FACT      | S3           |
| On 17 Feb 2026 ElevenAgents for Support launched workflows "without code."                                                | FACT      | S6           |
| The same Feb 2026 release says non-technical teams can update workflows, knowledge and guardrails in a no-code interface. | FACT      | S6           |
| Current sales page advertises no-code call flows with an intuitive drag-and-drop builder.                                 | FACT      | S7           |
| Current page advertises templates for SDR, appointment setting and collections.                                           | FACT      | S7           |
| Current page advertises Salesforce/HubSpot updates and calendar sync.                                                     | FACT      | S7           |
| The developer-focused/no-code distinction has materially weakened since the stated snapshot.                              | INFERENCE | S1,S3,S6, S7 |

**Wording lock. Allowed:** "may have been more defensible around the January snapshot" and "has since weakened." **Not allowed:** "the January builder score was wrong" or "ElevenLabs now has builder parity."

## 7. Strategic context - relationship boundary

| Evidence point                                                                                                                                   | Status                                  | Source       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------|
| TechCrunch reports CEO Finn zur Muehlen said telli voices were cloned using ElevenLabs or Cartesia.                                              | FACT - independent / direct attribution | S4           |
| ElevenLabs raised \$500M at an \$11B valuation and said it would double down on ElevenAgents across CX, sales, marketing and internal workflows. | FACT - primary                          | S5           |
| Current telli use of ElevenLabs is not established.                                                                                              | NOT ESTABLISHED                         | -            |
| A technology layer used by telli historically has expanded into the operational layer telli now compares against.                                | INFERENCE                               | S1,S3-S5, S7 |

## 8. Fresh proof and constrained use

Fresh primary evidence, 2 Sep 2026. ElevenLabs reports that its internal AI SDR, Dom, handled \$1M+ in qualified pipeline in one month, reached 92% qualification accuracy and saved 180 SDR hours. This is evidence that ElevenAgents is being used in a production sales workflow at ElevenLabs itself.

**Critical boundary. Dom handles inbound today. The article says outbound sequences such as initial outreach and follow-up are a next step. Do not use Dom as proof that ElevenLabs has already proven outbound SDR performance in production. Current outbound capability is supported separately by the product pages and the 2025 Batch Calling release.**

## 9. Public comparison system - follow-on question

The live telli page links an eight-provider comparison set: Vapi, Regal AI, Synthflow, Retell, Fonio, Parloa, Bland and ElevenLabs. This brief tests only ElevenLabs. It does not establish that the other seven pages are stale.

**Paid decision frontier: Which claims across the full public comparison layer should telli defend, narrow, retire or rebuild when each page is tested against current competitor product state, sales objections and internal win/loss evidence?**

## 10. Dropped or constrained items

| Item                                 | Decision            | Reason                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Fastest-growing part of ElevenLabs" | Dropped             | No sufficiently strong direct evidence found for the exact claim.                           |
| 28 May 2026 no-code citation         | Dropped / corrected | The 28 May article is 2025 Batch Calling. No-code support evidence is 17 Feb 2026.          |
| LinkedIn hackathon relationship      | Dropped             | Not required; no independently fetched primary evidence used.                               |
| "Current supplier became competitor" | Not used            | Only historical 2025 use is established; current relationship is unknown.                   |
| "Dom proves outbound"                | Not used            | Dom is inbound today; outbound sequences are next step.                                     |
| "ElevenLabs has parity"              | Not used            | Feature/capability evidence does not establish full platform parity or quality equivalence. |

# 11. Method and QA notes

- 1 Research was limited to public sources. No private telli or ElevenLabs data was used.
- 2 Primary sources are treated as evidence of what each vendor publicly states, not independent proof of product quality.
- 3 The two timelines are intentionally separated: outbound/campaign capability versus builder/no-code accessibility.
- 4 Absolute statements were narrowed where the evidence only supports an inference.
- 5 No claim is made about lost deals, buyer trust damage, parity, or current supplier status.
- 6 The brief is designed to create a decision question, not to prescribe telli's internal strategy from public evidence alone.